ESP 168B Winter 2022

Teaching Assistant Xiurou Wu

Winter Quarter 2022
Selected Evaluations* (3)

UNIVERSITY OF CALIFORNIA - DAVIS

Student Evaluation of Teaching

Enrollment 54
% responding 27%

	Excellent		Very Good		Satisfactory		Fair		Poor					
	5	%	4	%	3	%	2	%	1	%	$\bar{x}$	SD	M	N
Please indicate the overall educational value of the course. (excellent | very good | satisfactory | fair | poor)	5	33%	6	40%	4	27%	0	0%	0	0%	4.1	0.8	4.0	15
Please indicate the overall teaching effectiveness of the teaching assistant. (excellent | very good | satisfactory | fair | poor)	9	60%	4	27%	2	13%	0	0%	0	0%	4.5	0.7	5.0	15
Indicate the effectiveness of the organization of the discussion or lab section (e.g., syllabus, order of information, instructor availability) in promoting your learning.	11	73%	1	7%	3	20%	0	0%	0	0%	4.5	0.8	5.0	15
Indicate the effectiveness of the content (e.g., discussion, lab activities, lecture review) of the discussion or lab section in promoting your learning.	9	60%	3	20%	3	20%	0	0%	0	0%	4.4	0.8	5.0	15

ESP 168B Winter 2022

What specific aspects of the course most contributed to your learning?

Lectures were most important in my learning.

Learning the different types of impact evaluation.

I appreciated the weekly readings and supplemental assignments

homework helped me visualize the concepts better

I felt that the course was structured so that concepts were built upon in a logical way, which I greatly appreciated. Furthermore, looking at different papers to show how a certain method was employed was also very helpful! I think it helped concepts feel abstract.

The short answer assignments.

Discussion is where I learned and understood the concepts.

The discussion section and lectures were helpful.

discussion sections where we focused on analysis of specific things

Real-world application of methods for policy/program outcomes

I loved how practical it was. Sanchirico teaches us a new topic, goes over hypothetical examples to engage the theoretical breakdown of the method and how we measure different variables, then we break down an entire case study from cradle to grave. Honestly, one of the best and most applicable classes UC Davis has to offer. Would be great if we had guest speakers like Dr. Perri, I mean, we go over their work! :)

I found the problem sets and discussion section really helped me understand the concepts and what the key takeaways were. I also really enjoyed the videos and podcasts included in lectures and would have enjoyed even more of those!

The short answer assignments directly inquired about the concepts we were learning about. The professor's lecturing abilities and interactiveness were excellent.

What specific aspects of the course least contributed to your learning, and what specific changes would you make to improve the course?

Discussion did not lead to much learning, as we mainly just repeated lecture material.

I think the class should be more accessible by uploading the annotated slides and allowing us to view recordings even without doctors notes.

I thought the exams were poorly organized and confusing

I really did prepare and learn concepts for the midterm but it did not translate. There were unnecessary tricky criteria to get the points

I think mathematical examples done in class for values we need to know how to calculate should be explained more thoroughly. Furthermore, the written notes being inaccessible after the lecture does not feel conducive to a good learning environment. I would recommend that if current learning conditions continue given the pandemic, in-person recordings should be made available without the condition of a doctor's note.

Lecture. The lectures went extremely fast and difficult concepts were covered with little in depth explanation. I did like the professor and how he did in the news and played podcasts.

Lecture recordings were not always available. Also the in person lecture was much more engaging than zoom.

The lectures and powerpoint were pretty material heavy and the lectures were a little too fast paced to follow. I wish the material had been simplified a little bit for people that are not super familiar or experts in policy analysis. It was pretty difficult to follow.

n/a

ESP 168B Winter 2022

non-environmental examples

Being online really sucked, but that is not Sanchirico's fault, nor Xiurou's fault. Online learning just sucked. In-person was SO MUCH BETTER.

I think many of the lectures were extremely dense. In the transition to in person learning, it has been a long time since many of us have had to sit in one room for an hour and a half. It became difficult to follow especially towards the end of the class period. I would suggest maybe adding lighter material towards the end like the "in the news" section put at the end of class instead of the beginning.

I think the slides/ppts have room for improvement as they are VERY dense with information which makes it hard to follow along concurrently with what the professor is saying. I think the professor's unwillingness to post his written slides was a bit perplexing/problematic as someone who takes notes with their laptop. Having to take pictures in-person and to import them into my electronic notes make his writing notes difficult to see as it is quite small. On some occasions I would just miss it altogether or having to re-take the pictures several times as he added/cramped in more information within the slide. Also the exams I personally felt were very long and difficult, along with being graded very stringently/strictly. Despite being open-book, I struggled with being able to effectively answer/apply the concepts even with preparing/studying for the exam a week beforehand up until the exam. I would recommend/consider extending the time or lightening the content of the questions inquired as the content of the class is naturally dense.

What was the most important thing you learned in this course overall, either in terms of content or new skills, that you would expect to use in the future?

Learning more research methods and how to analyze research is always important.

The math formulas for regression and causal impact.

N/a

not sure

In general, different methods for establishing a valid counterfactual given the circumstances of the data/experiment.

I learned about how to run experiments

I learned impact eval methods and applications of them which I will likely use in my career in Environmental Policy.

I learned about different policy analysis methods.

i learned more about how to evaluate policy and how complex it can be

Discerning what makes a good/bad policy/program

Applications of methodologies to real studies. Most importantly, how to control to eliminate or mitigate bias, and get more accurate results to apply externally.

How policy research is designed was very enlightening. I'm not sure whether the content or skills will be relevant in my future career as I feel it is more relevant for those who are pursuing graduate school.

What advice would you give students who are considering taking this course next year?

Go to lecture, listen carefully, and just keep going.

You need to know yourself and how you can best engage in the material, or else you will feel lost. For me, I had to take handwritten notes to pay attention.

Potentially going over short answer assignments in office hours before turning them in

beginning of the course is a bit confusig of what the idea of what the course is about.

Do the readings and start the homework ahead of time.

ESP 168B Winter 2022

Go to class and discussion. It helps a lot because you get notes and examples that are hard to understand on your own.

Just ask questions whenever you're confused if you need further clarification.

go to lectures and pay attention! most of the information is provided but you do need to apply some critical thinking to really understand the topics.

Do the readings as soon as you can so that you have some basic idea before attending lectures and completing the short answers that build on those basic concepts

I would ask them how much they like research papers and the methods and brainpower that go into planning an experiment. Also, think outside the box, as the exams are applicable, and hypothetical scenarios, not regurgitation - which I really like and find really valuable.

Start the assignments early and work through the study guide throughout the quarter, not right at the end near the exam.

Go to lecture and focus on what the professor is saying rather than the slides.

What most contributed to your learning in discussion section or lab?

Some of the videos and podcasts were helpful and well-presented.

Going over examples and assessing our knowledge with polls.

I preferred discussion, I thought I learned more and the material was condensed

videos

Mathematical examples that Xirou talked us through, and then had us do independently to see how we were doing!

Xiurou

Walking through examples and the non graded polling/quizzing throughout the zoom. It helped me understand a lot better.

The little reviews of lecture.

i enjoyed the check in survey questions in the discussions.

Answering the pop-up questions

Xiurou is an amazing and passionate Ph.D. candidate. Really cares about the students, and makes herself available for questions. Very good at crafting hypotheticals on the spot to explain and help us understand topics.

Our TA was incredible! She made discussion section fun, engaging, and easily accessible. I really appreciate all the work she put into finding resources, videos, and slides to help us better understand the material. I learned a lot from her in discussion setcion!

Questions/polls asked on zoom that Xiurou would clarify or explain after.

What aspects of the discussion section or lab least contributed to your learning, and what changes would most improve your learning in discussion section or lab?

The polls/questions were useful, but not super useful. All we had to do was listen the barest amount to get things right, but I'm not sure that helped us for the exams.

We should discuss the answers to the short answers more.

I thought the class was kind of confusing and found it hard to follow in class. I recommend having more smaller assignments that are weighted more and potentially a group/individual large project instead of large exams considering the course averages were very low.

ESP 168B Winter 2022

polls
Podcasts
Nothing! Discussion was very helpful.
N/A
n/a
n/a
Online was bad, and also, I like when we have time to discuss a question with our partner. I find that more valuable than being lectured at in discussions.
N/A
Being online allowed for me to participate as someone who is shy and less outspoken.

ESP 168B Winter 2022

Term	Eval Opened	CRN	Subject	Course	Section	Enrollment	% Response
Winter Quarter 2022	3/4/2022 12:00 AM	24430	ESP	168B	A01	16	31
Winter Quarter 2022	3/4/2022 12:00 AM	24431	ESP	168B	A02	14	42
Winter Quarter 2022	3/4/2022 12:00 AM	24432	ESP	168B	A03	24	16